



DEADLY CARGO

This B-52 (left) is being loaded with Cruise missiles, which guide themselves to their target using the features they fly over as a reference. This system allows a high degree of accuracy.

CONTROL CENTER

The long life of the B-52 is partly due to the regular updating of its onboard systems (right), including the navigational devices, radar, and radar-jamming equipment.



ENGINE MAINTENANCE

Two highly skilled engineers work on one of the B-52's eight powerful turbojet engines.



Escape/ejection hatches

Electronic countermeasures antenna

Forward undercarriage with twin wheels

External fuel tank with a capacity of 582 gallons (2,650 liters)

Outrigger wheel

DISTINCTIVE FEATURES

Some of the defining features of the B-52 are visible from a front view: the eight engines, which generate massive thrust; the long, swept-back wings; the stabilizing outrigger wheels; and the external fuel tanks at the end of the wings.

Specifications (B-52G)

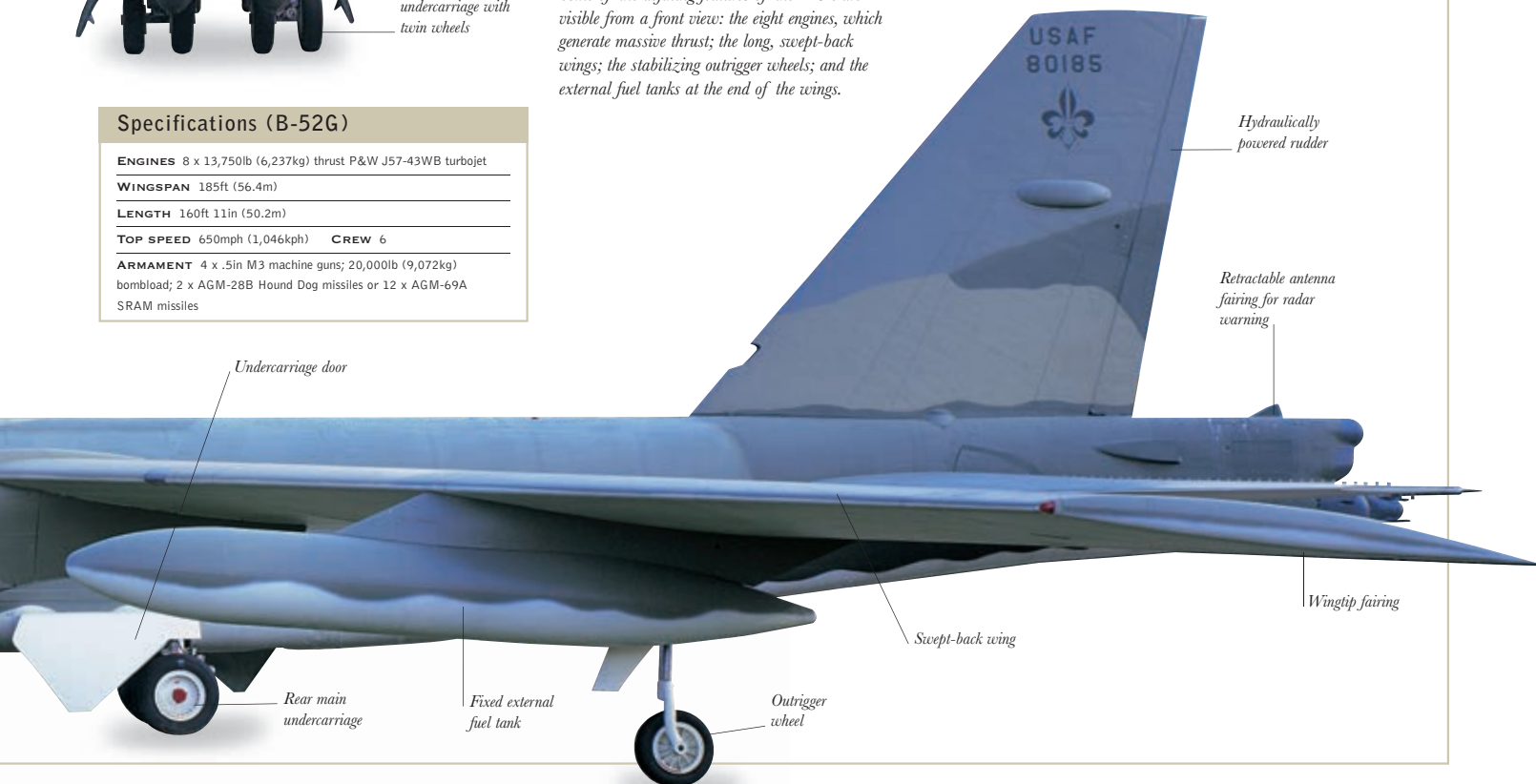
ENGINES 8 x 13,750lb (6,237kg) thrust P&W J57-43WB turbojet

WINGSPAN 185ft (56.4m)

LENGTH 160ft 11in (50.2m)

TOP SPEED 650mph (1,046kph) **CREW** 6

ARMAMENT 4 x .5in M3 machine guns; 20,000lb (9,072kg) bombload; 2 x AGM-28B Hound Dog missiles or 12 x AGM-69A SRAM missiles



Undercarriage door

Rear main undercarriage

Fixed external fuel tank

Outrigger wheel

Swept-back wing

Hydraulically powered rudder

Retractable antenna fairing for radar warning

Wingtip fairing